SARDINIAN WINTER BLUES

SELECTED POEMS

MATTEO MUSCAS

COLOUR OF RUNAWAY DOG

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CEILINGS

Cold tall ceilings.
Cold small hands, yours.
I wrap myself in my trench-coat.

His cold, colder body
in front of a distracted audience.
An old man perched on the pulpit –
Inaudible speech in the distance.

Grieving relatives
an easy explanation
for the Unexplainable mystery
Us here, staring at him
here no more.

There is no comfort
in the sunshine illumining -
your sleepless face.

Old woman: apparition up the aisle,
carrying a basketful of tingling
profane coins. Someone sobs.

I stare at the old lady
at all those money
She looks at me.
A cold afternoon in January.

She claims that after all it's not too bad. She claims. There are flies, that she gets to try and catch. Flies make her do that funny sound.
Silence.
She repeats that yes - clearing her voice - it's not all that bad.
I nod.
Moving closer, tuning down my voice. Brain tells me I would not want people to hear me.
But there is nobody around.
I turn my own volume down.
Perfectly pitched, pure, empty universe.
I tell her. I tell her last time, last time I've seen her, she seems to be perfectly fine. In good appetite, she says. In good appetite, I confirm. Brain tells me to keep on talking. Brain itself replies he froze (I froze).
I scratch my head. Words come out slow, like a leaking faucet, like water dripping on a sink at night and you forget to close the door, and you hear the sound, metronomically precise, like a japanese train, like taxes. Like a convict waiting for the hangman.

You know, I have never thought much of you.

Though you gave me food last time we saw each other.

True.

Silence joined us. Sat between us. (time near the center of a black hole). I stood, holding my mug - Awkwardness flavored tea inside, progressively colder - between my hands.
The discomfort of a moment in all its beauty. In all its ironical majesty.

You know. It's a shame you're gone. After all, it is.

I get on my feet, considering the possibility of carrying on our pale, stale, derailed conversation. Decided that no, interlocution time has reached its end. Light outside, unrealistically bright.
Dark paintbrushes of soft wooden brown here.
I walk to the door to open it more dramatically that I wanted to.

Take care of yourself - I say getting out.

The door closes behind me.

the initial - and somehow -
final stage of our relationship.
of all the interesting accurate weather dissertations.
(very cold outside, by the way. very). millions of pages
gazillions of topics
Proust, Freud, E.L. Fucking James
in a millisecond.
we salute, only saying our names. nodding.
and leaving.

curtain /ˈkɜː.təən/ (actors walk in) - Matteo.
he nods.

I nod too. - Stefano.

(curtain comes down) over us.

born in this

into this

video poker and scratch cards

unemployment and torpor

horse fillets and crab meat

welfare state and anarchy

always waiting for a train
parked elsewhere -
in a perpetual strike.

land of traditions, stubbornness
blue sky, grey grumbles,
turquoise sea, beige complaints.

I miss you, Sardinia
only from a distance.

your warm sun on my skin
I'm a stranger here, home.
I'm a stranger, there, home.

you're a siren that attracts me and shipwrecks me
your nasty, awful, charming appearance
drives me to your rotten core
to people with no hope
imagination, dreams.
Broken.

I miss you, Sardinia.
I really do. When I'm elsewhere.

LOVE SONG



TANGENT LINES

Tangent lines, you and I.
Destined to touch
in one point
to then drift
away
forever

Lost in our journeys,
You
and I,
We meet
and fade.

We were on a boat.
A ferry boat
full of the memories
of what we used to be.
I looked for you

You were never there
You have never been

I turned around
to meet the gaze of a ghost.

I turned around
and you weren't there.

The ship sailed.